Air Heroes

User Manual

A board game about clean energy and air quality

Version 1.0

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1. Introduction

Welcome to Air Heroes! This is a web-based board game designed to teach you about clean energy, air quality, and how everyday choices affect the environment. Race across the board, answer trivia questions, complete minigames, and battle pollution bosses while keeping your Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) as low as possible.

Air Heroes can be played solo or with up to three players.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Opening the Game

Air Heroes runs directly in your web browser. No download or installation is required. To start playing:

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge are all supported).
2. Navigate to the game's page on itch.io.
3. Click the "Run Game" button to launch Air Heroes in your browser.

2.2 Main Menu

When the game loads, you will see the Main Menu. From here, you can:

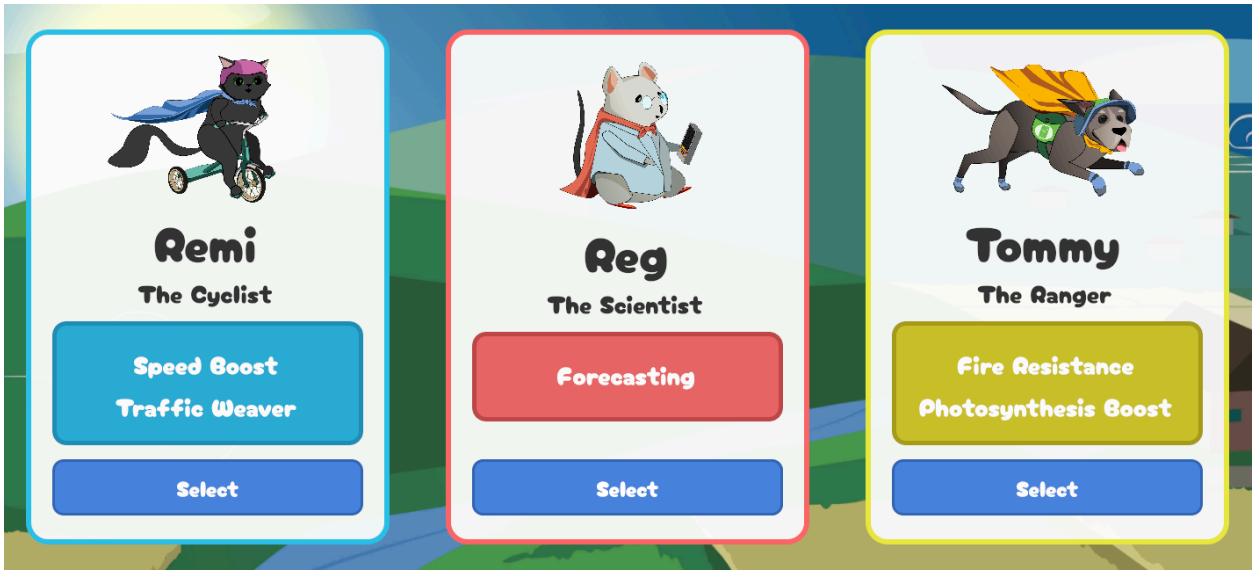
- Start a singleplayer game
- Open the Settings page to adjust your preferences
- Start a multiplayer game (2-3) players

2.3 Settings

The Settings page lets you customize your game experience before you start playing. You can access it from the Main Menu or while in game.

3. Choosing Your Character

Before the game begins, each player selects a character. Each character has unique abilities that affect how they interact with the board.



Character	Abilities
Remi the Cyclist	Moves an extra tile when landing on green squares. Ignores traffic pollution, making Remi a great choice for staying ahead on the board.
Reg the Scientist	Can use his sensor up to twice per game to reveal the correct answer to a trivia question. Perfect for players who want a safety net on tough questions.
Tommy the Ranger	Immune to wildfire events and cleans twice as much pollution when landing in forest areas. Ideal for keeping your AQHI score low.

3.1 Remi the Cyclist

Remi is all about speed and avoiding traffic-related pollution. When Remi lands on a green square, he moves one extra tile forward as a bonus. Remi also completely ignores pollution effects caused by traffic, so your AQHI won't increase from those events. Choose Remi if you like to move quickly and stay ahead of the other players.

3.2 Reg the Scientist

Reg carries a special sensor device. Twice per game, you can activate the sensor to reveal the correct answer to a trivia question before you answer it. This ability is very powerful, so save it for the toughest questions. Choose Reg if you want extra help with the knowledge-based parts of the game.

3.3 Tommy the Ranger

Tommy is a nature protector. He is completely immune to wildfire events that would normally increase your AQHI. When Tommy lands on a forest tile, he cleans up twice as much pollution

as other characters. Choose Tommy if you want to focus on keeping your AQHI as low as possible throughout the game.

4. Understanding the Score (AQHI)

Your score in Air Heroes is measured by the Air Quality Health Index (AQHI). Unlike most games, a lower score is better. The AQHI represents how clean the air is around your character.

How the AQHI works:

- Your AQHI starts at 0.
- Certain events on the board (like landing on pollution squares) will increase your AQHI.
- Good actions (like answering trivia correctly or completing minigames) can help lower your AQHI.
- Your goal is to finish the game with the lowest AQHI possible.

5. How to Play

5.1 Rolling and Moving

On your turn, you will roll a virtual die to determine how many spaces you move.

1. Click the die (or the Roll button) to roll.
2. Your character will automatically move forward the number of spaces shown on the die.
3. When you land on a square, its effect will activate. See the section below for what each square type does.
4. After the square's effect resolves, your turn ends and the next player goes (in multiplayer), or you roll again (in solo play).

5.2 Board Squares

The board is made up of different colored squares. Each color triggers a different event when you land on it:

Color	Type	What Happens
Gray	**Pollution**	Landing here increases your AQHI. Pollution events represent real-world sources of air contamination such as traffic, factories, or smoke.
Green	**Minigame**	Landing here launches a minigame challenge. Complete the minigame successfully to earn rewards and reduce your AQHI.
Blue	**Fact / Trivia**	Landing here presents a trivia question about clean energy or air quality. Answer correctly to lower your AQHI.

5.3 Boss Battles

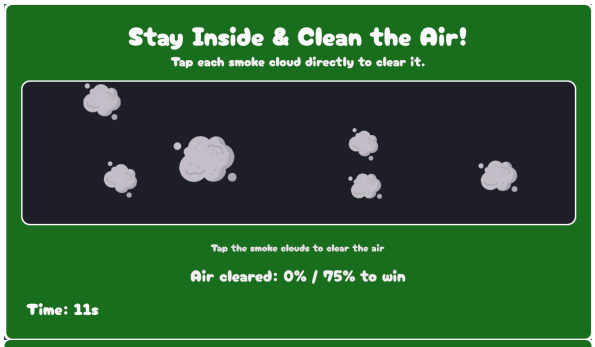
At the end of the board, you will face a Boss Battle. This is the final challenge before the game ends.

1. When you reach the boss square, the boss battle begins automatically.
2. You will be asked three trivia questions in a row.
3. You must answer all three questions correctly to defeat the boss.
4. If you miss even one question, you lose the fight and gain pollution.

6. Minigames

6.1 Clean The Air

- Rapidly click to disperse smoke and reduce pollution!

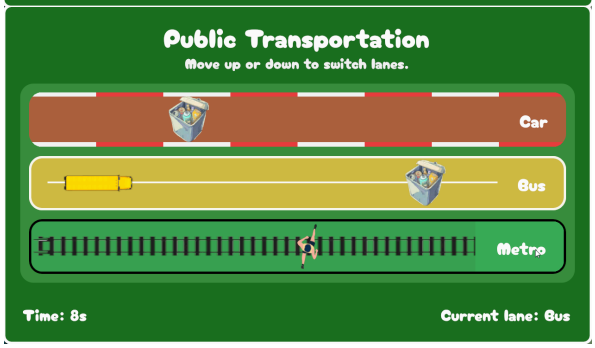


6.2 Recycling

- Drag each item into a Paper, Plastic, Metal, or Compost waste bin. Earn score for each correct answer!

6.3 Public Transportation

- Move up and down between transportation methods to avoid roadblocks!



6.4 Clean Energy

- Choose the clean energy source from the options to reduce pollution!

6.5 Biofilter

- Choose an order to place Gravel, Sand, Charcoal, and Plants into your biofilter. You will receive points based on your order of the materials.

6.6 Tree Planting

- Click rapidly to plant trees! Reduce pollution

6.7 Save Energy

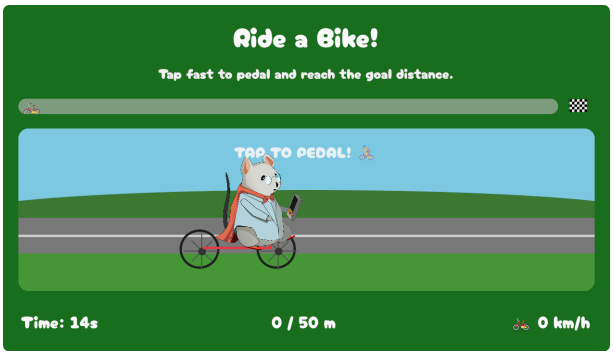
- Click to turn off lights in lit rooms to reduce waste. Waste builds every second a light is left on, keep it low to reduce pollution!

6.8 Use A Mask

- Click and drag the correct respiratory mask to Remi to protect from pollution!

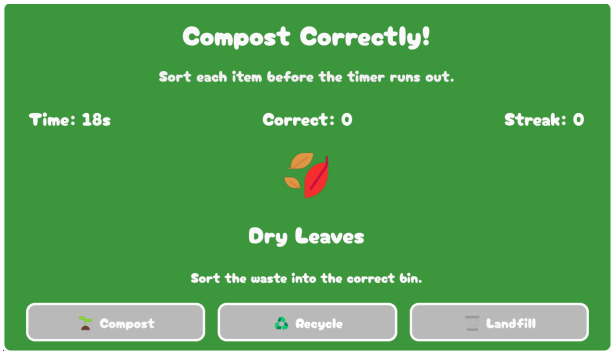
6.9 Ride A Bike

- Click to accelerate Reg through his commute. Get there in time to reduce pollution!



6.10 Composting

- Sort the items into Compost, Waste, or Recycle to reduce pollution!



7. Multiplayer Mode

Air Heroes supports up to three players in multiplayer mode. Here is how multiplayer works:

1. On the Main Menu, select the number of players (2 or 3).
2. Each player selects a character.
3. Players take turns rolling the die and moving across the board.
4. Each player has their own AQHI score throughout the game.
5. After all players have completed the board (including the boss battle), the player with the lowest AQHI wins!

Thank you for playing Air Heroes!